AN ARC OF UNCERTAINTY

MUCH OF THE 3,488 KM-LONG INDIA-CHINA BORDER IS NOT CLEARLY DEFINED ON THE GROUND. MIRED IN COMPETING CLAIMS, THESE ARE THE FLASHPOINTS THAT NEED TO BE RESOLVED ACROSS THREE SECTORS

WESTERN SECTOR: LADAKH

Difficulty: VERY HIGH

DEPSANG PLAINS: Part of India's Darbuk-Shyok-Daulat Beg Oldi (DBO) road passes through, connecting Leh, Siachen and access to Karakoram Pass. China worried about DBO airstrip, as its Xinjiang-Tibet G219 highway through Aksai Chin runs parallel to Depsang. Stand-offs in 2013-15 as China wants the commanding heights. Heavy buildup from 2020. Disengaged in 2024

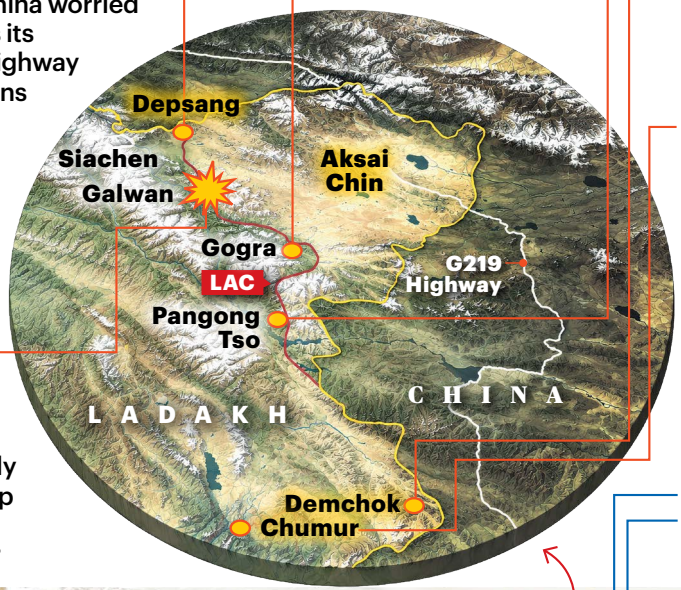
GALWAN VALLEY: Patrolling Point 14 saw the Jun. 2020 clash of Indian and Chinese soldiers. Early disengagement, troop withdrawal in Feb. 2021 with 2 km buffer

GOGRA HOT SPRINGS Unmarked border south of Galwan where friction arose on patrolling points, with China moving into PP-15 and PP 17A in Apr.-May 2020. Disengagement in Sept. 2022

PANGONG TSO: Dispute on eight ridges—'fingers' 1-8—on lake's north bank. India claims LAC till Finger 8, China claims till Finger 2, occupied Fingers 4-8 in 2020. Withdrawal in 2021

DEMCHOK: Dispute on placement of line along Charding Nullah. Standoffs in 2014, 2016; build-up of troops after 2020. Disengagement in 2024

CHUMUR: South of Demchok, area of 16-day standoff in 2014 over Chinese construction across LAC. Limited tension after 2020



MIDDLE SECTOR

Difficulty: LOWEST

HIMACHAL PRADESH

KAURIK AND SHIPKI LA: China claims Chuva-Chuje area near Kaurik; area south of Shipki La pass. No border tension

UTTARAKHAND

NILANG, JADHANG, PULAM SUMDA Originally claimed by Tibet before 1947; now claimed by China

BARAHOTI: Site of incursion in 1954, still claimed by China

